ENERGY IN THE HOME 3.3

LOSING HEAT

Why do some things cool down faster than others? What things would affect how fast they cool down?

Your task is to plan and carry out an experiment to test if the type of material a container is made of will affect how fast it cools down.

You can use the following pieces of equipment:

1. glass beaker
2. copper beaker
3. plastic cup
4. thermometer
5. stopwatch
6. clingfilm (to use as a lid)
7. boiling water from a kettle

*** Remember that you must make it a fair test by keeping everything the same except the type of container.

*** Also remember that the thermometer may take a minute or so to adjust if it is suddenly placed in hot water.

You must present a plan of your experiment before you start with a labelled diagram of what it will look like and how you will collect information (results) and show it (graphs). The teacher will also give you a mark for carrying out the experiment (handling equipment).